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An atom-photon quantum gate using an atomic clock qubit and a birefringent cavity

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Abstract

Single atoms coupled to optical cavities provide a powerful platform for photonic quantum information processing. Minimizing the influence of external factors like magnetic field fluctuations is a key goal in this endeavor. In this work, I investigate a novel gate protocol that employs a single ^{87}Rb atom prepared in a magnetic-field-insensitive clock qubit and coupled to a high-finesse birefringent FabryPerot cavity. The cavity's high birefringence creates two well-separated polarization eigenmodes, enabling polarization-selective reflectivity that depends on the atomic qubit state. This allows for the implementation of a controlled phase (CPHASE) gate between the atomic clock states and our photonic qubits. By rotating the basis of the photonic qubit, one is then able to realize an atom-photon controlled-NOT (CNOT) gate.

Show some results here and talk about how well it works and also how one might be able to use the gate

I present simulations based on inputoutput theory and master-equation modeling that quantify the conditional reflection amplitudes, gate truth table, and resulting fidelities under realistic experimental imperfections such as finite mode matching, cavity loss channels, and multiphoton contributions. Our results indicate that atom-state-dependent phase shifts on the photonic qubit are achievable in the current system, providing a viable path toward a robust, high-fidelity, cavity-assisted atomphoton quantum gate.

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Chapter 1

Introduction

Few theories have reshaped modern technologies and thus our day to day life as profoundly as quantum mechanics when it was discovered in the early 1900s. The examination of the black-body radiation of celestial bodies such as our sun and later formulation of the Planck's law by Max Planck, explaining the quantized energy exchange between a black-body and a radiation field, laid the ground work for many theories and technologies. Among these is the laser which is based on Einstein's theory on stimulated emission [1], both used in day to day life (e.g. the barcode scanner at the register, or scanner within a computer mouse) as well as research (e.g. Sisyphus cooling [2] or trapping of atoms in a MOT [3]). Another technology of great importance is the atomic clock, which is based on Norman Ramsey's work [4], allowing for the clear definition of a single second [5]. One piece of technology, which for the average person, stands above all of those, is that of the transistor, specifically the MOSFET transistor. The MOSFET transistor is the most used type of transistor found in modern electronics [6] that either allows or denies the passage of electrical current. By either blocking the current or letting it pass through the component, one forms the foundation for all modern electronics, namely that of a *bit*. Interestingly enough, the theory which explains the passage of current through such a device, that being the electronic band structure model, is again rooted in quantum mechanics.[7]

In an attempt to predict the following years of chip evolution, Gordon Moore made the bold assumption in 1965 that with each coming year, the number of components crammed on an integrated chip will double [8]. This statement would later on be known as *Moore's Law*, and would pave the way for chip manufacturers to keep on increasing the amount of transistors in their chips, in order to subconsciously keep up with the predictions made by Moore. Back in the day, with the way technology was evolving, this enthusiasm towards simply increasing the amount of transistors by following a "plenty of room at the bottom"-mentality from the likes of Richard Feynman [9] and thus achieving an increase in computing performance, would eventually hit fundamental limits. In order to pack more transistors onto the same sized computer chip, the transistors themselves would need to be shrunk down. However in recent years, this approach of increasing computing performance has led to the realization that simply going smaller, does not yield the hoped-for performance increase. [10]

As the tasks one concerns themselves with become much more intricate, like finding the most efficient delivery route for a logistics company[11], or accurately simulating small subsystems [12, 13, 14], it's clear that classical computation has hit a limit and a new kind of computation platform is needed. As Feynman points out in his talk "Simulating Physics with Computers":

“Nature isn't classical, dammit, and if you want to make a simulation of nature, you'd better make it quantum mechanical, and by golly it's a wonderful problem, because it doesn't look so easy.”[12]

This has paved the way for a new form of computing, called *quantum computing*, which instead of using fixed bits that can either be a 1 or a 0, this new type of computer uses the so called *qubits*, which in itself is a two-state quantum-mechanical system, and can be placed in any *superposition*

state $|\psi\rangle = \alpha|0\rangle + \beta|1\rangle$. That is, until a measurement is performed and the state collapses back to being either $|0\rangle$ or $|1\rangle$ again. What makes the qubit interesting however, is the relationship multiple qubits can have with one another, and that they can be *entangled* with one another, thus not allowing for description of one qubit state, without the state of another qubit. By leveraging these two fundamental quantum mechanical principles, many protocols have been implemented that in theory should outperform their classical counterparts. Be it in the realm of encryption where certain quantum algorithms now promise an exponential speedup [15], in quantum key distribution where the laws of quantum mechanics enable fundamentally secure communication [16], or in the transfer of quantum states between distant nodes via quantum teleportation [17].

However, as time went on, and different hardware platforms were investigated that could serve as a foundation for a quantum computer, one problem (along many others), became apparent: scalability. As one tries to increase the amount of qubits used in a quantum computer, being able to keep external noise and errors that each component produces at bay, becomes more and more of a challenge[18]. In order to be able to scale these new systems up, it was proposed that instead of building one large quantum computer, where one would try to keep errors at bay via error correction algorithms integrated into the fundamental structure of the computer [19], one would instead split the computation horsepower up into multiple smaller decentralized pieces.[20, 21] Each of these pieces would then represent a single quantum node, that is able to create entanglement between a stationary atom and a mediating qubit, transfer the state of the mediating qubit onto the stationary one, and also process information through the use of quantum logic gates. By linking many of these quantum nodes one aims to overcome size-scaling and error-correction problems that would limit the size of machines for quantum processing.[21, 22]. This network of nodes would then appropriately be named a *Quantum Internet*. One way of realizing such a quantum internet is via the strong coupling interaction of single photons and atoms in the setting of cavity quantum electrodynamics (*cQED*). Here, each quantum node would store a set number of stationary atoms in between two highly reflective mirrors, which are able to be individually controlled, and interlinked with one another through another set of quantum channels, realized by photons that travel in between the nodes through optical fibers.

One of these cavity systems is the *CavityX* systems at the Max Planck Institute for Quantum Optics which features a ^{87}Rb atom trapped in between two crossed fiber optic cavities, hence the letter X in the name. In the past this setup has been used in order to achieve atom-photon entanglement with a fidelity of 87% [23], successfully transfer the information from a photonic qubit onto an atomic qubit with a fidelity of 94.7%[24], and recently realize atom-atom entanglement between two nodes connected via a fiber going through the Munich city center all the way out to research campus in Garching while still achieving a fidelity of include number and citation here. However as mentioned before, in order to realize a full quantum internet, the last milestone is the realization of the processing nature of the quantum node part mentioned in the definition of the quantum internet by Jeff Kimble [21]. This is where this thesis comes into play. The goal of this thesis is to realize an atom-photon reflection gate using one of the two fiber cavities in the CavityX setup, that one being birefringent, while preparing the atom in either of the two clock states of the D₂-line ground states, thus minimizing the influence of external factors like magnetic field fluctuations. Using a setup inspired by [20] and storing the information in the polarization of a photonic qubit, has the advantage of allowing for controlled gate operations between a flying photon and a resonantly coupled atom trapped inside of the cavity. With the realization of a quantum gate between a stationary atom and a flying photonic qubit, one would be able to reuse this setup to build further quantum nodes as such and thus completing the final requirement for a fully functional quantum network node, ready for integration into a Quantum Internet.

Include the structure of thesis once Pau is done giving me his verdict

Chapter 2

Theory

This chapter introduces the theoretical framework needed to understand the key points of this thesis. First a general introduction into cavity quantum electrodynamics will be given, alongside the intricacies in the setup that will modify the general theory. Afterwards the reflection from an atom-cavity system will be explored, and finally how it can be used to construct an atom photon gate.

2.1 Cavity Quantum Electrodynamics

The field of *Cavity Quantum Electrodynamics* explains the interaction between a resonator (in this case a Fabry-Perot cavity), and a piece of matter with which the light inside the resonator interacts (here: a ^{87}Rb atom). By placing the atom between two highly-reflective mirrors forming the optical cavity, one increases the number of times a photon that is inside a cavity bounces back and forth between the two mirrors, enhancing the interaction cross-section compared to free space. The strength of this enhancement is captured by the single-atom cooperativity $C = g^2/(2\kappa\gamma)$, which must satisfy $C > 1$ for deterministic light-matter interaction.[25]

The theoretical model which explains this interaction in a fully quantum mechanical picture is called the *Jaynes-Cummings Model* [26] and was named after Edwin Jaynes and Fred Cummings who developed it in 1963. To introduce this model, we consider a three-level emitter (i.e. the atom), which is interacting with a single cavity optical mode.

The *Jaynes-Cummings* (JC) Model describes the coherent exchange of energy between a quantized cavity field and a two-level transition of the atom. The cavity supports a single optical mode at frequency ω_c . The atom, which is also located in the cavity, supports a transition frequency close to ω_c , from a coupled state $|c\rangle$ to an excited state $|e\rangle$ at a frequency ω_a . This transition is treated in the dipole approximation. In order to then complete the three-level-emitter picture, we include an uncoupled state $|u\rangle$ with which the photon does not interact due to this state not being resonantly coupled to the cavity light mode. This uncoupled state $|u\rangle$ is what enables the conditional atom-photon gate operation.

Lastly, any real atom-cavity system, additionally suffers from losses, primarily the spontaneous decay of the atomic excitation at a rate of 2γ and the cavity field decay at a rate κ .

The full Hamiltonian which describes interaction between the atom and the cavity thus reads: [26]

$$\mathcal{H}_{\mathcal{JC}} = \underbrace{\hbar\omega_c\hat{a}^\dagger\hat{a}}_{\text{cavity field}} + \underbrace{\hbar\omega_a\hat{\sigma}_{ce}^\dagger\hat{\sigma}_{ce}}_{\text{atom}} + \underbrace{\hbar g(\hat{a}\hat{\sigma}_{ce}^\dagger + \hat{a}^\dagger\hat{\sigma}_{ce})}_{\text{light-atom interaction}} \quad (2.1)$$

The three terms in (2.1) describe the energy of the cavity field, the energy of a bare atom, and the coherent coupling between the two governed by a coupling strength g .

The operators $\hat{a}^\dagger$ and $\hat{a}$ are the creation and annihilation operators of the cavity light modes, whereas $\hat{\sigma}_{ce}^\dagger = |e\rangle\langle c|$ and $\hat{\sigma}_{ce} = |c\rangle\langle e|$ are the atomic raising and lowering operators, respectively.

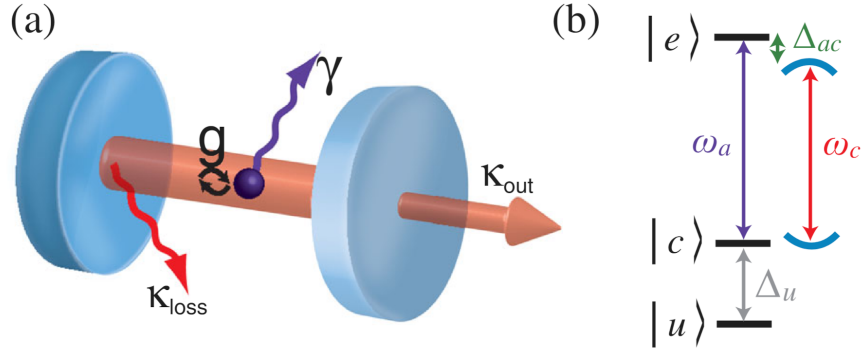


Figure 2.1: include citation to rempe reiserer paper

The form of (2.1) assumes the so called *Rotating-Wave Approximation* in which fast oscillating terms at optical frequencies can be neglected.

Solving for the eigenenergies of the system one is left with:

$$E_0 = 0 \quad (2.2)$$

$$E_{\pm}(n) = n\hbar\omega_c + \hbar\frac{\Delta_{ac}}{2} \pm \frac{\hbar}{2}\sqrt{\Omega_n^2 + \Delta_{ac}^2}, \quad n \in \mathbb{N} \quad (2.3)$$

In (2.3), n is the number of excitation quanta in the system, with $\Omega_n = 2g\sqrt{n}$ being the corresponding n -quanta Rabi frequency. The term Δ_{ac} describes the detuning of the cavity resonance frequency from the atomic transition. The main take-away from (2.3) is that on resonance ($\omega_a = \omega_c$), the eigenenergies of the system are split by $2\hbar g\sqrt{n}$, giving rise to the so-called *Vacuum Rabi Splitting*.

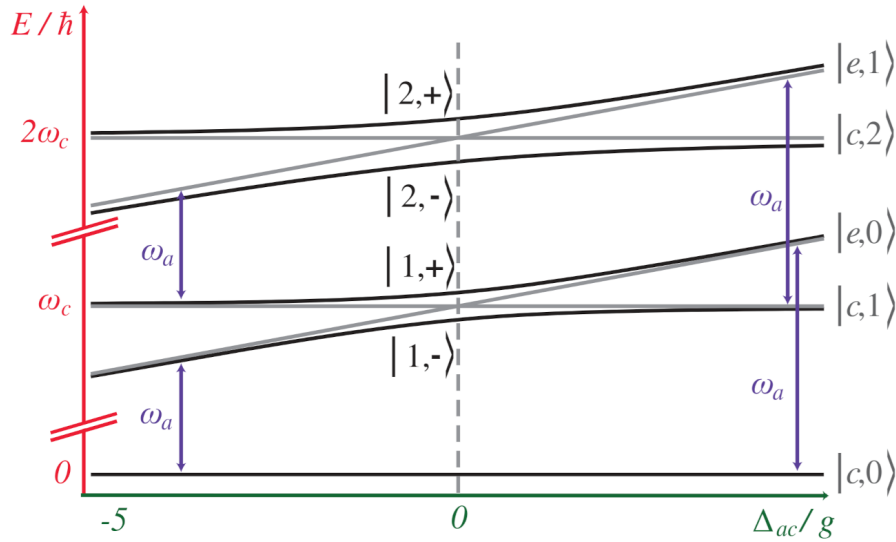


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2.1.1 Birefringent Cavity

Equation (2.1) only covers the case for having a single cavity light-mode. The setup used in this thesis, however, features a birefringent cavity. The birefringence is created by physically changing the geometric shape of the cavity mirror during production of the fiber ends.[27] This forces a change in the optical path lengths between different polarizations, leading to a frequency splitting $\Delta\nu$ proportional to the ellipticity ϵ of the mirror surfaces:[28]

$$\Delta\nu = \frac{\nu_{FSR}}{2\pi k} \frac{\epsilon^2}{R_2}. \quad (2.4)$$

The property ν_{FSR} in (2.4) describes the free spectral range, $k = \frac{2\pi}{\lambda}$ the photon wavenumber, and R_2 the radius of curvature of the cavity mirror.

This means that we need to consider a system with two different light modes for the JC Hamiltonian, which in this case are the π and the V modes. However only the π mode is resonantly coupled to the $|c\rangle \leftrightarrow |e\rangle$ transition, whereas the V mode is detuned by $\Delta_{\text{biref}} = 2\pi \cdot 500\text{MHz}$. In the context of this thesis $\Delta_{\text{biref}} \gg \kappa, g, \gamma$. This effectively makes the V -mode uncoupled, and can be neglected in the analytical treatment. It is, however, still included in the Hamiltonian for use in numerical simulations where both modes are driven explicitly. This leads to the extended Hamiltonian:

$$H_{JC} = \hbar\omega_{c,\pi}\hat{a}_\pi^\dagger\hat{a}_\pi + \hbar(\omega_{c,\pi} + \Delta_{\text{biref}})\hat{a}_V^\dagger\hat{a}_V + \hbar\omega_a\hat{\sigma}_{ce}^\dagger\hat{\sigma}_{ce} + \hbar g(\hat{a}_\pi\hat{\sigma}_{ce}^\dagger + \hat{a}_\pi^\dagger\hat{\sigma}_{ce} + \hat{a}_V\hat{\sigma}_{ce}^\dagger + \hat{a}_V^\dagger\hat{\sigma}_{ce}) \quad (2.5)$$

2.1.2 External Drive

At the heart of the atom-photon gate lies the reflection of the incoming photon off the cavity system. In order to describe this in a quantum mechanical way, one needs to include a driving term in the Hamiltonian with the form of $H_{D,S} = i\hbar(\epsilon e^{-i\omega_d t} + \epsilon^* e^{i\omega_d t})(\hat{a} + \hat{a}^\dagger)$. This Hamiltonian $H_{D,S}$ is defined in the Schrödinger picture, and has a complex drive amplitude ϵ and driving field frequency ω_d . After applying the rotating wave approximation (RWA), which neglects the fast oscillating terms in $H_{D,S}$, and changing into the rotating wave frame to remove the explicit time dependence, one gets the following expression:

$$H_D = i\hbar(\hat{a}_s\epsilon^* + \hat{a}_s^\dagger\epsilon) \quad (2.6)$$

where $\hat{a}_s$ denotes the annihilation operator of the cavity mode matching the input photon polarization ($s = \pi$ or V).

Adding (2.6) to (2.5), one gets the following full Hamiltonian:

$$\begin{aligned} H_{JC} = & \hbar\Delta_{c,\pi}\hat{a}_\pi^\dagger\hat{a}_\pi + \hbar(\Delta_{c,\pi} + \Delta_{\text{biref}})\hat{a}_V^\dagger\hat{a}_V + \hbar\Delta_a\hat{\sigma}_{ce}^\dagger\hat{\sigma}_{ce} \\ & + \hbar g(\hat{a}_\pi\hat{\sigma}_{ce}^\dagger + \hat{a}_\pi^\dagger\hat{\sigma}_{ce} + \hat{a}_V\hat{\sigma}_{ce}^\dagger + \hat{a}_V^\dagger\hat{\sigma}_{ce}) \\ & + i\hbar(\hat{a}_s\epsilon^* + \hat{a}_s^\dagger\epsilon) \end{aligned} \quad (2.7)$$

This then gives a definition of the JC Hamiltonian with respect to an external driving field, and based on the detunings of the driving field with respect to the cavity resonance frequency $\Delta_{c,\pi} = \omega_{c,\pi} - \omega_d$ and the atomic transition frequency $\Delta_a = \omega_a - \omega_d$, respectively.

2.2 Reflection from a Cavity-Atom System

For quantum information processing, it is essential that the photonic qubit is preserved upon reflection from the cavity. This requires that light entering through the first mirror called the outcoupling (OC) mirror also exits through the same mirror, rather than being lost through the opposing highly reflective (HR) mirror. The HR mirror on the other hand must have maximum reflection, making

the cavity one sided, so the light exits predominantly through the OC mirror. The total losses can thus be divided into the following parts:

$$\kappa = \kappa_{oc} + \kappa_{HR} + \kappa_{paras} \quad (2.8)$$

In (2.8), κ_{oc} and κ_{HR} describes the rate at which light couples into and out of the cavity through the OC and HR mirror respectively, whereas κ_{paras} describes the rate of losses due to absorption at the mirror surfaces. In order for the light to enter and leave through the OC mirror, one needs to ensure that $\kappa_{oc} \gg \kappa_{HR}, \kappa_{paras}$. The escape probability of the photon is then defined by the outcoupling ratio $\frac{\kappa_{oc}}{\kappa}$.

Another important quantity is the matching of the spatial modes of the light when coupling into the cavity. As the incoming light gets coupled into the cavity, a mismatch between the spatial modes in transmission and reflection can occur. This lowers the efficiency at which the light can couple to the cavity itself. The mode matching is then given by the overlap integral of the mode functions for the light one is investigating. In this case it is important to quantify the mode matching between the reflected light at the first cavity and the incoming light (μ_{fr}) as well as the one for the incoming light and the optical mode inside of the cavity (μ_{fc}).

The field incident on the cavity is treated as an input field. This then can be linked to an output field via input-output formalism. When driving the system only from one side, as it is the case here, the relation between input and output becomes:[29]

$$a_{out}(t) = \mu_{fr}a_{in}(t) + \mu_{fc}\sqrt{\kappa_{oc}}\langle a \rangle(t) \quad (2.9)$$

Here (2.9) was adjusted to also consider the mode matching parameters. Solving Langevin equations for weak coherent driving and photonic wave envelopes which vary only on a time scale longer than κ , one can write down the analytical representation of the reflection amplitude[30, 31, 32]:

$$r(\omega) = \mu_{fr} - \mu_{fc}^2 \frac{2\kappa_{oc}(i\Delta_a + \gamma)}{(i\Delta_{c,\pi} + \kappa)(i\Delta_a + \gamma) + g^2} \quad (2.10)$$

The reflection amplitude in (2.10) depends on the detuning $\Delta_{c,\pi} = \omega - \omega_{c,\pi}$ between the driving laser frequency and the cavity resonance frequency $\omega_{c,\pi}$ (for the π mode) and on the detuning relative to the atomic transition frequency $\Delta_a = \omega - \omega_a$.

Include reflection spectrum for different detunings and also phase across different detunings

2.3 Conditional Reflection

Looking at (2.10) one can see that the behavior of the reflection amplitude at zero detuning ($\Delta_a = \Delta_{c,\pi} = 0$) is:

$$r(\Delta = 0) = \mu_{fr} - \mu_{fc}^2 \frac{2\kappa_{oc}\gamma}{\kappa\gamma + g^2} \quad (2.11)$$

In the event of an uncoupled atom-cavity system (effectively $g = 0$), which would be achieved by preparing the atom in the $|u\rangle$ state, the reflection coefficient $r < 0$. This would imply a relative phase shift of π between the reflected and incoming light field ($a_{out}(t) \approx -a_{in}(t)$). Preparing the atom in the coupled state $|c\rangle$ however, the Vacuum Rabi Splitting shifts the cavity resonances to $\omega_c \pm g$, so the cavity appears off-resonant for a photon at ω_c . The photon is therefore reflected from the OC mirror without entering the cavity, acquiring no phase shift, which is mirrored by a reflection coefficient of $r > 0$ ($a_{out}(t) \approx a_{in}(t)$). A V polarized photon, being far detuned from the cavity resonance by Δ_{biref} , is reflected without entering the cavity and acquires no phase shift, regardless of the atomic state. This state-dependent phase shift of the output field depending on the state of the atom, enables the realisation of a quantum atom-photon gate with the atom being the controlling qubit and the photon being the target qubit.[20]

2.3.1 Reflection in CPF basis

Adopting standard quantum computing notation, the uncoupled state of the atom is the $|0\rangle$ state, and the coupled one the $|1\rangle$ state. The photon, either π -polarized or V-polarized, is represented as the input states $|\pi\rangle$ and $|V\rangle$. Furthermore, for all input states, the input drive is resonant with the π mode of the birefringent cavity.

For an input state $|0, \pi\rangle$, meaning the atom is prepared in the uncoupled state $|0\rangle$ and a π -polarized photon is sent in, the photon will be able to enter the cavity and (ideally) exit through the OC mirror, with a π phase-shift. For the input state $|1, \pi\rangle$, the Vacuum Rabi splitting shifts the cavity resonance away from the photon frequency, causing it to be reflected without a phase shift. When sending a $|V\rangle$ photon, it will get reflected off of the OC mirror regardless, due to the birefringence of the cavity. This results in the following reflections:

$$\begin{aligned} |0, \pi\rangle &\rightarrow -|0, \pi\rangle \\ |0, V\rangle &\rightarrow |0, V\rangle \\ |1, \pi\rangle &\rightarrow |1, \pi\rangle \\ |1, V\rangle &\rightarrow |1, V\rangle \end{aligned}$$

This output from the atom-photon reflection gives us a *Controlled Phase Flip* (CPF) gate. This conditional phase shift allows the construction of a universal quantum gate that can be transformed into any two-qubit gate using rotations of the individual qubits, which in the case of the photon can be done via retardation waveplates.

2.3.2 Reflection in CNOT basis

Rotating the photonic basis states to

$$\begin{aligned} |+\rangle &= \frac{|V\rangle + |\pi\rangle}{\sqrt{2}} \\ |-\rangle &= \frac{|V\rangle - |\pi\rangle}{\sqrt{2}} \end{aligned}$$

and keeping the atom either in the coupled ($|1\rangle$) or uncoupled case ($|0\rangle$), results in the following reflection:

$$\begin{aligned} |0, +\rangle &\rightarrow |0, -\rangle \\ |0, -\rangle &\rightarrow |0, +\rangle \\ |1, +\rangle &\rightarrow |1, +\rangle \\ |1, -\rangle &\rightarrow |1, -\rangle \end{aligned}$$

In the new photonic basis $\{|+\rangle, |-\rangle\}$, the CPF gate is equivalent to a controlled-NOT (CNOT) gate, with the atom as the controlling qubit and the photon polarization as the target qubit. The photon polarization is flipped ($|+\rangle \leftrightarrow |-\rangle$) when the atom is in $|0\rangle$, and left unchanged when the atom is in $|1\rangle$.

Chapter 3

Atom-Cavity platform

The system uses a single ^{87}Rb coupled to a birefringent Fabry-Perot cavity inside of an ultra-high vacuum (UHV) chamber. The smaller optical beam path used for the realization of the atom-photon gate, is part of a much larger setup which uses two Fabry-Perot cavities in an X formation, thus giving it the name *CavityX*. For the atom-photon gate, parts of the setup like the magneto optical trap, the 850nm red-detuned trap laser, and the microwave antennas integrated into the UHV chamber, are crucial. Other components, most notably the second cavity, is not within the scope of this thesis, but will be discussed in the outlook.

3.1 Cavity system

At the heart of the CavityX system are the two crossed fiber cavities which are named the "short" cavity (SC) and the "long" cavity (LC), which are distinguishable by their lengths ($79\mu\text{m}$ vs. $161\mu\text{m}$) as the name suggests, and also by the fact that the short cavity is birefringent. Each cavity fiber is held in place by an in-house built holder shown in figure 3.1.

The incoming light is coupled in and out via the single-mode (SM) mode fiber for either of the cavities. In order to ensure that most of the coupled light exits through the SM fiber, different mirrors coatings are used for the fiber surfaces. The multi-mode (MM) fiber surfaces are coated with a highly reflected dielectric coating, while the opposing SM fiber, has a dielectric coating with a lower reflectivity (10ppm transmission vs. 340 ppm transmission). This leads to most of the coupled-in light to then exit the cavity through which it entered the system.[33]

The cavity fibers are fabricated using a CO_2 laser machining technique by the one of the previous PhD students *Manuel Brekenfeld* in [27]. Changing the beam profile of the CO_2 laser allows for the fabrication of either spherical or elliptical surfaces like it's the case for the short cavity.

Show transmission plot for both the LC and KC (plots are in gianvito's thesis)

The cavity parameters for the short cavity can be taken from the thesis of the current PhD student *Gianvito Chiarella* in [33], except for the mode matching, coupling strength and the linewidth, as these were measured for a different transition than the one used in this thesis.

3.2 Trapping of a singular atom

3.2.1 Magneto-optical trap

In order to realize an atom-photon quantum gate, one is required to have an atom trapped inside of the cavity with which the photon can then interact with. Therefore one needs to properly position the atom and keep it trapped at the position where it most efficiently couples to the cavity to ensure

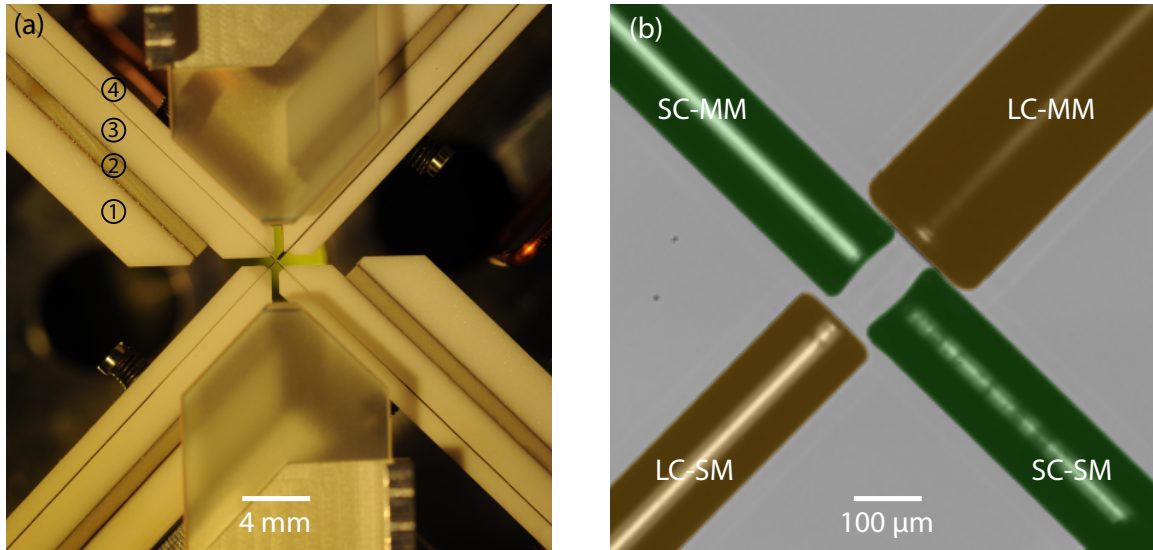
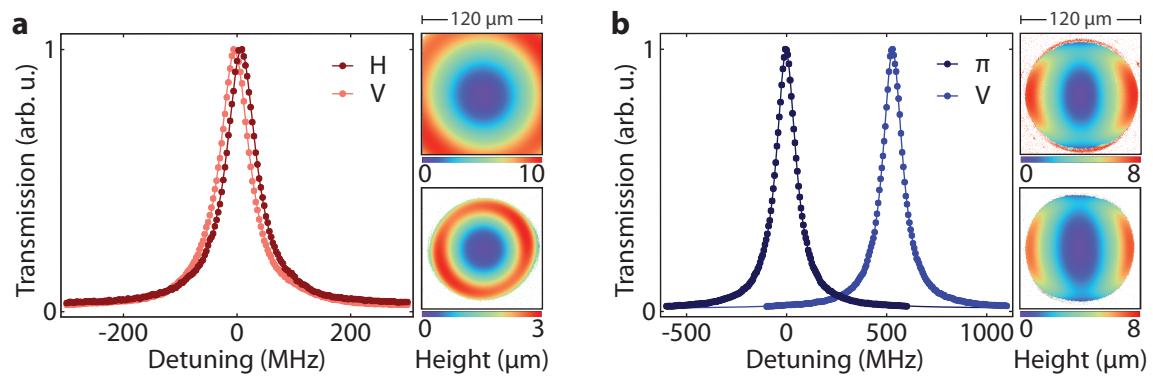


Figure 3.1: Experimental setup showing the short and long fiber cavities.[33] [look at gianvito's thesis](#) and write down what he did there, also ask him if it's cool to use the figure



the most efficient gate operation.

The starting point for this is the trapping of an atomic cloud via a magneto-optical trap (MOT). Once the atomic cloud is trapped, one turns off the MOT, causing the atoms to fall down due to the gravitational force, from which singel atoms can then be loaded into the cavitie's center. The concepts of a MOT are explained in [34].

In order to trap atomic clouds via a MOT, one needs to generate in this case a Rubidium vapor inside of the UHV chamber. This is done via light-induced atom desorption (LIAD), in which atoms are dispensed from a Rubidium dispenser that is placed inside of the vacuum chamber. The light-source is a UV diode *ILH-XQ01-S410* with an emitting wavelength of 410nm, which is pulsed for the length of the time needed to load the MOT.

The MOT loading procedure can be divided into 2 sections:

First comes the loading phase in which the MOT coils, the MOT beams (a cooling laser and a repumper laser), and the UV light are switched on simultaneously. This then creates the atomic cloud and cools it down to a temperature close to the ^{87}Rb D_2 -line Doppler temperature of 146 μK . [35]

Lastly an optical molasses is applied, which aims at bringing the atom to a temperature much below the Doppler limit. Here the detuning of the MOT beams is increased, whereas the optical power is decreased.

At the end of the MOT cycle, the MOT coils, beams and the UV light are switched off.

Table 3.1: Parameters used for the MOT loading phase.

MOT coil current	23.5 A
UV diode current	140 mA
MOT beams' diameter	12 mm
Loading phase	
Duration	1.4 s
Cooling laser detuning from $5S_{1/2}, F = 2 \leftrightarrow 5P_{3/2}, F' = 3$	check detuning again
Repumping laser detuning from $5S_{1/2}, F = 1 \leftrightarrow 5P_{3/2}, F' = 2$	0 MHz
Cooling laser power	20 mW
Repumping laser power	250 μW
Molasses phase	
Duration	1 ms
Cooling laser detuning from $5S_{1/2}, F = 2 \leftrightarrow 5P_{3/2}, F' = 3$	-31 MHz
Repumping laser detuning from $5S_{1/2}, F = 1 \leftrightarrow 5P_{3/2}, F' = 2$	-20 MHz
Cooling laser ramp-down power	1.7 mW
Repumping laser power	250 μW

Parameters used for the MOT loading phase. The UV diode and the MOT coils are permanently on the whole time. The cooling and repumping laser power is measured behind a polarizing beam splitter, which separates the horizontal MOT beam from the top-diagonal ones.

3.2.2 Trapping and positioning of singular atom

At the end of the MOT loading phase, the ultra-cold atomic cloud then sits approximately 10mm above the cavity plane. Turning off the MOT, causes the atoms to fall down towards the cavity due to gravity, until they reach the cavitie's crossing point, where at that time laser beams for cooling and trapping the atom are turned on.

The cooling and repumping laser are shone diagonally onto the crossing point in a counter-propagating configuration. Using orthogonal polarizations in a lin $\perp$ lin for the counter-propapagating lasers, the

atoms are cooled to sub-Doppler temperatures via Sisyphus-cooling.

Once the atom is at the center of the cavity, 2 lasers are responsible for keeping it trapped there: The first one is the intracavity laser of the short cavity which has a frequency of 772 nm, and is blue-detuned from the D_2 -line. The laser self-interferes in the cavity, forming a standing wave, thus confining the atom at the node i.e. interference minima. Stabilizing the cavity length is achieved by first locking the intracavity laser using the PDH-lock technique and then locking the laser frequency to an optical frequency comb, which serves as a stable frequency reference. For the atom-photon gate the frequency of the laser was chosen so that the cavity is resonant to the D_2 -line at 780nm, which is also known.

The second laser is the 852nm vertical trap laser, that's shone in from the top of the cavities' crossing point. The laser is linearly polarized along the long cavity axis, and focussed to a diameter of about $20\mu m$. Afterwards it is then transmitted through the chamber and collimated to a mode diameter of 1cm. Lastly it gets transmitted through a dichroic element, a set of retardation waveplates, a piece of silica glass mounted to a galvanometer scanner (galvo), to then get retroreflected in a cat-eye configuration. Due to the laser being far detuned from the D_2 - and D_1 -line of the atom, it forms a trapping standing wave, where the atoms are confined in the antinodes- i.e. interference maxima.

In order to achieve maximum cavity coupling, the galvo is scanning the amplitude, thus rotating the silica glass modifies the beam's refraction angle, effectively changing in the optical beam path length, which then moves the antinodes either up or down with respect to the vertical axes of the trap laser. While this is happening, the fluorescence counts coming from the atom during the cooling phase, are collected via the short cavity and detected with superconducting nanowire single-photon detectors (SNSPDs). Live-monitoring the fluorescence counts detected via the SNSPDs which analyzed in real-time with an FPGA that also scans the amplitude of the galvo, one can determine the height and thus the maximum coupling position of the atom by looking at the fluorescence counts. In order to ensure that only a single atom was trapped instead of a two badly coupled one's, the FPGA sequence is as follows:

1. The FPGA starts scanning the voltage of the galvo while monitoring the amount of fluorescence counts detected in a 25ms window coming from the atom.
2. If the fluorescence counts go above a certain threshold (noise-threshold), this means that an atom that's weakly coupled to the cavity is emitting fluorescence counts into the cavity.
3. The FPGA then continues increasing the voltage, keeping track of the voltage (i.e. position) at which the maximum fluorescence counts were reached, while also adding the amount of clicks in a span of 25ms at each galvo step into a single 32-bit register. This effectively represents an integral over the fluorescence counts vs. galvo amplitude curve.
4. Once the fluorescence counts drop below the (noise-threshold), meaning that the atom has been move out of the cavity center, the integral of the fluorescence counts is evaluated. If the integral is within a certain range, the FPGA will set the voltage at which maximum fluorescence counts were detected. If the integral is out of range (too low: atom was badly coupled anyways; too high: multiple atoms were in one node), the galvo keeps scanning until it either finds a new atom, or reaches the maximum amplitude, causing the MOT and single-atom positioning loop to start again.

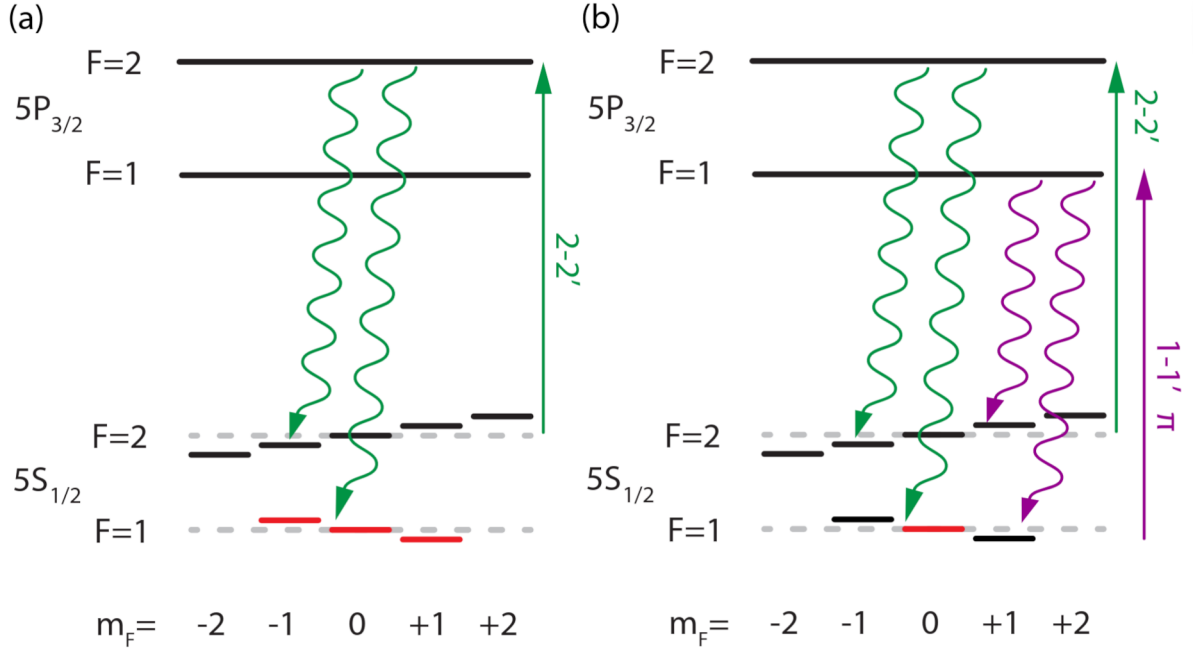
A different atom-positioning algorithm was employed in the past (e.g. the one used in *Gianvito Chiarella's* thesis [33]), where the FPGA only scanned up to the point where the maximum fluorescence counts were reached. This past algorithm had the possibility of loading two atoms which were badly coupled to the cavity since there was no way of distinguishing this case from the one of a properly coupled atom. By completing the scan over the entire fluorescence-counts-curve, one is able to properly ensure single atoms are being trapped. Mention something like the g2 or some metric that shows how this algorithm performs and also how it improved over the last algorithm, also do same measurement as gianvito in his thesis to showcase the loading algorithm cuz cool

3.3 Atomic-state preparation

For the atom-photon gate, the single atoms must be prepared in the two ground $m_F = 0$ ground states of the D₂-line, those being $5S_{1/2}, F = 1, m_F = 0$ for the uncoupled state, and $5S_{1/2}, F = 2, m_F = 0$ for the coupled state.

The first step in achieving this is to optically pump (OP) the atom into the desired state. This is done repeatedly exciting the atom from a level one wants to depopulate it from to an excited state, from which it will then decay into various ground states, determined by the dipole matrix element of the respective transition. In order to then populate the desired state, one uses a frequency for the pump laser, where all ground states one wants to depopulate are coupled to the excited state, except for the desired one, gradually populating it over time.

In this work, one first pumps the atom into the $F = 1, m_F = 0$ state. This is done by deploying two laser beams, one which is resonant to the $2 \rightarrow 2'$ transition of the D₂-line of ^{87}Rb , which will lead to the depopulation of the $F = 2$ manifold and population of the $F = 1$ manifold. In order to then populate only the $F = 1, m_F = 0$ state, one deploys another beam, resonant to the $1 \rightarrow 1'$ transition of the D₂-line. Furthermore the beam must be π -polarized, as in order to only populate the $F = 1, m_F = 0$ state, one needs to use the fact that the $F = 1, m_F = 0 \rightarrow F' = 1, m_F = 0$ transition is forbidden.[35]



Using this technique one is able to populate the $F = 1, m_F = 0$ level with a probability of $\geq 97\%$.[33]

For the atom-photon gate, one also needs to be able to prepare the $5S_{1/2}, F = 2, m_F = 0$ for the coupled state. This is achieved by first preparing the atom in the already prepared $F = 1, m_F = 0$ -state and using a set of microwave antennas integrated into the UHV chamber, to drive the transition via microwave pulses.

Finding the transition frequency is done by performing a microwave spectroscopy measurement, the atom is pumped into the $F = 1, m_F = 0$ via the previously discussed technique. By scanning the frequency of the microwave pulse while keeping the phase fixed, one can measure the population of the $F=2$ cavity-enhanced fluorescence state detection (SD) for $7.5 \mu\text{s}$.

The resulting MW spectrum shown in ?? then shows 3 peaks, which correspond to the $F = 1, m_F = 0 \leftrightarrow F = 2, m_F = 0$ and $F = 1, m_F = 0 \leftrightarrow F = 2, m_F = \pm 1$ transitions. From this one can infer

that the optical pumping into the $F = 1, m_F = 0$ is done with an efficiency of 97(1)%. [33]

show MW spectroscopy regarding the transition from $F = 1, m_F = 0$ to the other states

Once the frequency for the $F = 1, m_F = 0 \leftrightarrow F = 2, m_F = 0$ transition is known, one can coherently manipulate the atomic population in the ground state. By tuning the MW on resonance, one can drive Rabi oscillations [36] between two ground states, where the population evolution in the Zeeman state of $F = 2$ can be modeled as: [37]

$$P_2 = P_1 \cdot \frac{1}{2}(1 - \cos 2\pi\Omega t \cdot e^{-\chi t}) \quad (3.1)$$

where P_1 is the initial population after optical pumping in the state $F = 1, m_F = 0$, Ω is the before determined Rabi frequency, and χ is the damping rate. The result is a combination of a sinusoidal term which describes the coherent state transfer between our two levels, and an exponential factor representing the dissipative mechanism which damps the oscillations.

By scanning the length of the π pulse at a constant MW frequency, one can determine the ideal time it takes for a state to coherently transfer from $F = 1, m_F = 0$ to $F = 2, m_F = 0$. Figure ?? shows the resulting Rabi oscillations for an atom prepared in $F = 1, m_F = 0$ and transferred to the $F = 2, m_F = 0$ state. Fitting equation (3.1), write down fit params

Chapter 4

Photonic Qubit Path

4.1 Polarization-Dependent Losses

4.2 Inducing Losses via a Brewster Window Array

Brewster windows are a piece of uncoated UV fused silica, when placed at the so called brewster angle, that the p-polarized portion of the incoming light gets transmitted without any losses, while the s-polarized portion of the light gets partially reflected.

Using the system parameters and calculating the reflection amplitude via (2.10) it was apparent that the reflection from the atom-cavity system, introduces extra polarization dependent losses in the π mode as opposed to the V mode. Although the effect on the reflection in the CPF basis wouldn't be of any concern, it would lead to a reduced fidelity when measuring in the CNOT basis, as there the two polarization modes would need to have the same amplitude in reflection in order to show the expected flip from one state to the other.

In order to combat this and keep the fidelity high, an array of brewster plates were installed on a custom machined mount, which place the brewster plates at the brewster angle relative to the incoming light, so that the V polarized portion of the incoming light gets attenuated prior to interacting with the atom-cavity system. This ensures that in reflection, both polarization modes have the same reflection amplitude, allowing for the observation of the flip on the photonic qubit. The brewster angle can be simply calculated via:[38]

$$\tan \theta_B = n_t/n_i \quad (4.1)$$

$$n_t^2 - 1 = \frac{0.6961663\lambda^2}{\lambda^2 - 0.0684043^2} + \frac{0.4079426\lambda^2}{\lambda^2 - 0.1162414^2} + \frac{0.8974794\lambda^2}{\lambda^2 - 9.896161^2} \quad (4.2)$$

In (4.2) n_t is the optical density of the brewster window, and n_i would be the optical density from which the incoming light is coming from (here: air $n_i \sim 1.004$)

4.2.1 Custom brewster window mount

The custom brewster window mount as mentioned before has the main functionality of placing the elements in an array at the brewster angle θ_b relative to the incoming light. It can house up to 12 brewster windows when using the screw whole in the middle or 8 brewster windows, which allows the mount to be placed on two separate posts, making the overall mount more stable. The latter is the configuration eventually used in the setup, as alongside a more stable setup, the ideal fidelity laid between 6 and 7 brewster windows, which would make adding more windows useless **change that**. Furthermore, the brewster window mount has two sections in which the layout of one half is mirrored to that of the other half. The reason behind this is that at each transmission through the brewster window, the optical beam path gets offset, which significantly reduces the coupling into the cavity

fiber. In order to combat this, the other half of the brewster window placement was mirrored so that one half shifts the beam path up (relative to the direction of the into which the brewster window is pointing to **come up with a better way to explain this**), and the other shifts it back down. Although this is only the case for when the total amount of brewster windows is even and both halves are balanced, at most the shift would be equal to that of a single brewster window shifting the optical beam path, which is able to be compensating by realigning the input beam into the cavity fiber.

4.2.2 Characterization of brewster windows

For the characterization of the brewster windows themselves, two measurements were conducted. For the first one, only a singular brewster plate was inserted into the custom mount to check the average attenuation across a set of brewster windows in the V polarization. This ensures that all brewster windows operate up to spec, and that the attenuation of the V polarization is happening in constant jumps. The second one, places multiple brewster windows in an array to closely resemble the setup used in the actual experiment. With this one can then use the measured powers in transmission both for H and V to determine the ideal amounts of brewster windows one would need to use in order to achieve the highest gate fidelity.

4.3 Coupling into Cavity Fiber via Pellicle Beamsplitter

Before the construction of the current beam path setup, the only way to couple light, other than that of the intracavity laser, into the cavity, was done via the so called *probe beam*. The light coming from the probe beam would be coupled into the cavity-fiber, through the transmission of one and subsequent reflection off of another dichroic mirror. Each of these mirrors is a **include product names here** from the company **include company name here**, and possess the feature of transmitting most of the incoming light and reflecting only a small portion. This setup was chosen so that both the intracavity light trap and the probe beam could be coupled into the fiber simultaneously.

The problem with this way of coupling light into the cavity, for a beam where precise control over the polarization and its losses is crucial, was the fact that in reflection the dichroic mirrors were introducing additional polarization dependent losses in the s and p polarization. An earlier setup chose to still couple light into the cavity when reflecting off of the dichroic mirror, while including a set of compensation waveplates to map the H and V polarization of the incoming light to the s and p polarizations of the dichroic mirror, and then another set of compensation waveplates right in front of the fiber cavity coupler to map s and p to π and V. However with no means to check the polarization of the reflected light from the dichroic mirror via a polarimeter, due to special constraints this proved to be unreliable.

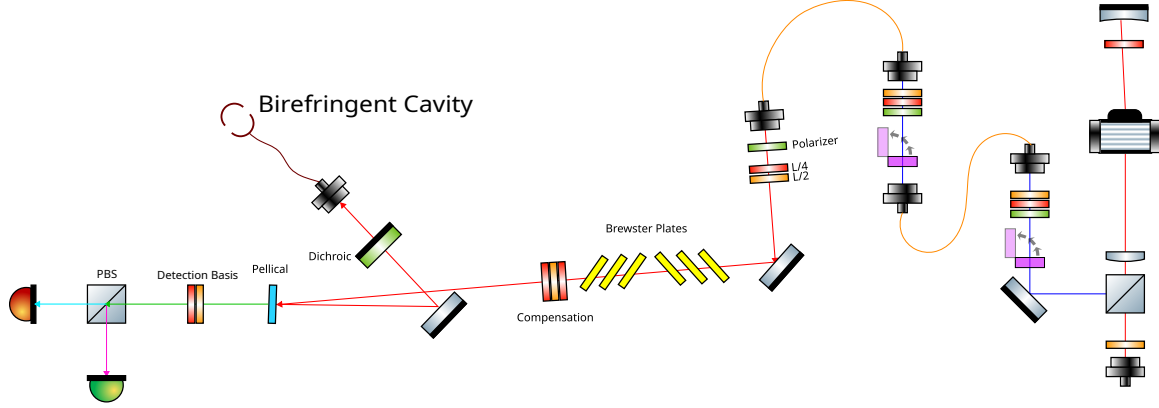
Finally by changing the placement of the beam coupler for the beam, and instead opting to use a pellicle, which had much smaller polarization dependent losses in reflection, one was able to circumvent the issue. Furthermore, one was able to verify that the polarization dependent changes both in reflection and transmission through the pellicle were minimal, thus ensuring that the correctly reflected light won't receive further penalties when going to the detectors.

include numbers that showcase the losses for each polarization and stuff for the dichroic mirrors and also for the pellicle (which are much smaller but still).

4.4 Optical Beam Path

For the atom-photon gate, weak coherent pulses are used in order to simulate the effect of single photons getting reflected from the cavity. It's therefore imperative to precisely control the power going into the cavity, and also the frequency which the light possesses. For that specific task the following setup was constructed:

Figure ?? showcases a double-pass AOM track which allows to offset the frequency of the incoming light by two times the frequency at which the crystal inside of the AOM is oscillating. The light going



into the AOM is blue detuned to the unshifted D_2 -line by **include actual offset**. Part of the laserlight (not shown here), can then be superimposed either with a stable reference frequency source like an optical frequency comb from the company *MenloSystems GmbH* when the laser frequency doesn't need to be tuned, or with another laser, for when the frequency of the laser needs to be scanned, e.g. for performing a normal-mode spectroscopy to determine the coupling strength g . Regardless of what the other source may be, one can then measure the optical beat signal via conventional photo detectors, and use the beat signal frequency as a feedback for the current of the laser one wants to stabilize the frequency of. The beam path also features two stages connected via polarization maintaining fibers (PM), at which ND filters can be flipped into the path in order to reduce the power giving rise to the weak coherent pulses needed for the gate.

After the AOM track, the light is then coupled into a PM fiber, where it then leads to the so-called *atom table*, at which the atoms are trapped, positioned, and prepared via the aforementioned methods. At the beginning of the track two automatically controlled waveplates allow for the setting of an arbitrary polarization which then gets sent through a set of brewster windows. The reasoning behind the usage of the brewster plates will be explained later. Afterwards a set of compensation waveplates ensures that the H and V polarized light going into the system, are mapped to the π and V mode of the eigenmodes of the cavity. The light then gets reflected off a pellical, which transmits most of the incoming light and reflects a small portion of our light ($\approx 1\%$), onto a mirror which then gets reflected off of a mirror, into the fiber cavity coupler.

The reflected light coming from the cavity then gets reflected off of the previously mentioned mirror, transmitted through the pellical at minimal losses, and coupled into the detection setup. Here, one can set an arbitrary polarization measurement basis via another set of automatically controlled waveplates. It is thus possible to map the reflected light in two modes which then get detected via two SNSPDs.

4.5 Reflection and Normal-Mode Spectroscopy

Chapter 5

Atom-Photon Gate

5.1 Characterization of system parameters

5.1.1 Cavity coupling and losses

5.1.2 Brewster plate attenuation

5.2 Atom-Photon gate performance

5.2.1 CPF and CNOT gate truth tables

5.2.2 Average gate fidelity

Chapter 6

Summary and Outlook

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